

5. Source: Minutes of Meeting with the German Ambassador, passed on by informants to local tribal leadership.

Date: October 10, 2023

Location: German Embassy

Attendees: German Ambassador, HfA Team from Geneva

a. Welcome and Introduction

German ambassador received the HfA team at the embassy.

b. Discussion on HfA's Operations and Security Incident

German ambassador inquired about HfA's operational status in the country.

She also asked about the recent security incident in Beta Town.

HfA team reported that the staff has been detained in their residence for several days, unable to leave until an agreement is reached between the organization and tribal leaders concerning health service maintenance in the district.

HfA team mentioned challenges due to tribespeople guarding the residence and their vested interest in the deal.

c. Government's Policy on Humanitarian Aid

German ambassador expressed concerns regarding the diversion of humanitarian aid to maintain development program. She sees the current security incident as an attempt to use extortion of HfA, and by extension the German government, to ensure the continuity of the dependency of Beta on international aid.

She emphasized that humanitarian aid should be allocated to conflict situations and not diverted to developmental issues. There are other programs of aid for development issue for which the government of Beta must be accountable.

Highlighted that countries should prioritize development themselves and not rely on humanitarian aid for such purposes.
Mentioned other organizations and frameworks are better suited for development projects.

d. Focus on HfA's war surgery specialization

The ambassador stressed the need for HfA to shift its operations to Gamma due to the ongoing armed conflict there.

Pointed out that HfA's surgical teams specialize in war surgery, making it more sensible to operate in conflict zones like Gamma rather than places like Beta.

e. Safety Concerns of HfA Staff

German ambassador expressed her concerns regarding the safety of the detained staff. Voiced confidence in HfA's professionalism, believing the organization would find swift solutions for the safe release of the staff.

f. Possible Compromise and Support

The HfA team asked the ambassador about potential compromises or solutions on the maintenance of health programs in Beta Town for the coming months to secure the staff's release.

The ambassador clarified that such decisions are beyond her authority and should be discussed with officials in Berlin.

Her current directive is to support the safe release of the staff and assist in redirecting humanitarian organizations to areas facing conflict crises.